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Participant 1 profile

age: 47,
education: PhD in economics,
gender: prefers not to say,
occupation: economist,
mother language: Portuguese,
level of English: Excellent

Interviews were conducted in English as the participant is a Portuguese residing in Estonia.

PRE experiment interview

1. Do you have any theoretical or practical experience with software development (building a web app, web page etc)?
2. Do you know any programming languages? Which?
3. What has been your experience with AI / LLMs? Do you use them? How often? How (most common usage)?
4. Do you know what vibe coding is? Have you had any experience with it? If yes, what kind?

Background in Software Development

- Speaker 1 has built webpages using Microsoft Word and Google Sites.
- No experience with web coding beyond these tools.

Programming Language Proficiency

- Speaker 1 primarily uses Stata and MATLAB frequently.
- Also uses Python, but is restricted at work due to firewall limitations, so uses it only on a personal computer.
- Has some experience with other programming languages in the past but does not recall details.

AI and Large Language Model Usage

- Speaker 1 uses AI and large language models habitually throughout the day.
- Uses AI tools for tasks in Stata, MATLAB, and Excel, such as coding instructions, renaming files, or handling data operations.
- Employs AI for general information and even in composing emails.

Vibe coding Knowledge

- Speaker 1 is not familiar with vibe coding and has not had experience with it beyond basic webpage creation with Word and Google Sites.
-

POST experiment interview

5. Did you achieve what you wanted to achieve?
6. How do you feel about the user experience? Any comments about using the platform?
7. Do you have any other thoughts, comments, ideas to share about carrying out the task (i.e. creating a piece of software with a vibe coding tool)?
8. Do you feel that you learned something from participating in the experiment?

Achievement and Verification

- The participant confirmed achieving their goals using the Lovable tool.
- They verified outcomes by manually checking recipe accuracy and comparing with source material.
- The tool successfully filtered out unnecessary brand mentions from commercial recipes, focusing on essential information.

User Experience with Lovable

- The tool was described as simple and easy to use, similar to ChatGPT in prompt-based interaction.
- There was some confusion about when the tool had finished processing responses.
- Editing prompts was only possible after the tool had stopped "thinking," unlike ChatGPT where prompts can be edited before submission.
- The participant desired a way to interrupt or abort processing to rephrase a prompt if necessary.

Creative and Technical Impressions

- The graphic design output was viewed as creative, with thoughtful color choices and gradients, producing a non-generic aesthetic.
- The participant was amazed by the tool's ability to allow non-programmers to build web apps, emphasizing how development becomes idea-driven rather than code-driven.
- Past experience with MATLAB was mentioned, but the participant highlighted that no programming knowledge was necessary for Lovable.
- They noted that prompt engineering tricks were not required to get professional results.

Learning and Overall Impressions

- The participant expressed that they learned the tool genuinely works and felt empowered to start creating more projects.

- They first heard about Lovable from a friend but had not tried it until now, expressing gratitude for the opportunity.
 - Overall, the experience was described as mind-blowing and exciting, with repeated positive remarks about the tool's capabilities.
-

Transcriptions

0:00

So we can start now.

0:02

So, uh, do you have any theoretical or practical experience with software development?

0:08

I don't know, like building some web app, webpage, something.

0:14

Um, I have built webpages with Microsoft Word.

0:19

With Word?

0:21

Yes-

0:21

Oh.

0:21

...

0:22

and with Google Sites.

0:23

Google Si- mm-hmm.

0:24

And, uh, that's it.

0:26

Okay.

0:27

Uh, then I wanted to ask if you know any programming languages.

0:32

Which ones?

0:33

I know, but it's for like data.

0:36

Hmm.

0:37

Stata, MATLAB, Python, and these are three that I use the most.

0:44

I have used in the past others, but I don't remember anything.

0:48

Okay, okay.

0:49

Yeah, it, it's just, you know, like just for background so, like-

0:52

Yeah.

0:52

...

0:52

maybe it might be interesting to kind of see, you know, maybe if there's something.

0:56

It's- It's Stata and MATLAB I use a lot.

0:58

Mm-hmm.

0:59

And Python I like to use, but for something like I could not use because we cannot download the packages because we are behind the firewall.

1:08

Oh, of course for security.

1:10

So, yes.

1:11

Ahh.

1:12

So but in practice, if I want to use Python, I need to use my personal computer, but since I'm...

1:17

I won't work in the office, then I don't use Python.

1:21

Okay.

1:22

And then the next question is about AI and large language models.

1:29

Have...

1:30

Do you have any experience with using AI, using large language models?

1:36

Yes, of course, like every day, every hour, every minute.

1:39

All the time-

1:39

How do you use them?

1:41

Uh, for example, I ask, I want to do something in Stata, I want to do something in-

1:45

Mm-hmm.

1:45

...

1:45

MATLAB.

1:46

I want to do a text, text like-

1:48

Mm-hmm.

1:49

Like for instructions and-

1:51

Y- Yes.

1:51

And, uh-

1:52

Like information.

1:53

...

1:53

e- even things like in Excel.

1:55

Like the other day for...

1:56

Yes.

1:57

The-

1:57

Yeah, yeah, yeah.

1:58

Me too, me too.

1:59

All, all the, all the time.

2:00

Same, same.

2:01

All the time.

2:02

Or like-

2:02

Um-

2:02

...

2:02

I, I, I have 10 files.

2:03

How do I rename them from one...

2:06

Like the other day in Stata, I want to memorize scalars in Stata, but I don't want to erase the database, that sort of thing.

2:14

Ho- how?

2:15

Oh s- Mm-hmm.

2:16

Mm-hmm.

2:16

Yeah.

2:17

I, I think-

2:18

It's like permanent.

2:18

...

2:18

I, yeah, I also use it day-to-day.

2:21

Yeah.

2:21

It's lo- it's like totally.

2:23

And sometimes even in emails, you know, and stuff.

2:26

Um, okay.

2:28

Then the last question, we already kind of briefly discussed it before, but like it's a...

2:32

Do you know what web coding is?

2:34

Mm-mm.

2:34

Uh, have you had any experience with it?

2:37

I think you had...

2:37

Just not had any.

2:40

No.

2:40

Okay.

2:41

Uh, but-

0:00

Uh, okay.

0:02

So, uh, do you feel...

0:04

did you achieve what you wanted to achieve with the gato?

0:06

Actually, I did.

0:07

Actually, I did, I did, I did, absolutely, absolutely.

0:10

Mm-hmm.

0:10

A- and I know that I did because these are two things that I could verify.

0:15

I already knew, um, the water recipe and then, okay, I had never yet cooked kimbap-

...

0:22

but I know what it is and I could check with the, the source, um, page, and yes, it worked.

0:29

So you actually did like QA, quality assurance.

0:33

You went and you tested manually-

0:36

Mm-hmm.

0:37

Yes.

0:38

...

0:38

if, uh, those particular cases, like if what the app that you created-

0:43

Yes.

0:43

...

0:43

if it actually generated like the correct-

0:46

Y- yes.

0:46

And, um-

0:47

...

0:47

solution for you.

0:48

Basically, th- this Lovable made the choices, so I didn't have to prompt it to make choices that make all the sense, like choice that I don't need to know any particular brand of ingredient.

1:03

So-

1:03

Oh, yeah, yeah, yeah.

1:04

...

1:04

so even though-

1:05

That's interesting.

1:06

...

1:06

i- it was collecting the recipe from this commercial website and the commercial website is like, "You used Gaud olive oil, so it's our brand." It, it removed that because this is not actually part of the recipe.

1:18

It doesn't matter.

1:19

So this, this is amazing.

1:19

That is very interesting, yeah, that it did it.

1:22

Huh.

1:22

Yeah.

1:22

It's...

1:22

A- and, of course, I didn't prompt them, the graphic design.

1:26

Okay, here I said, okay, it has to be, um, cute, but otherwise, like the choice of colors, like it, it i- this is not like the cheap version, like this is not like one, two colors.

1:37

It's one color, two colors, and then the second color, you know, moves into some-
1:41

Mm-hmm.
1:41

Gradients.
1:42

Mm-hmm.
1:43

It's, it's creative, you know?
1:45

So, yeah.
1:46

Okay, cool.
1:47

Um, yeah, so how do you feel about the user experience with the tool, the Lovable.
1:53

So, it, it, it was-
1:55

Are-
1:55

It was very simple to use, but it's so...
1:59

uh, it was not always clear that it has stopped thinking.
2:02

So I, I was-
2:02

Mm-hmm.
2:02

It was not clear for me, like can I prompt some more or, uh, and there was something a bit weird which was here.
2:11

Um, in ChatGPT, you can edit your prompt and then you press and everything's...
2:17

but here, you could not.
2:19

Um, no.
2:20

Okay, no, actually you can.

2:22

Ah, but, uh, what...

2:25

Uh, you can edit when it stops thinking.

2:27

Ah-huh.

2:28

Okay, so only after.

2:28

Okay, okay, okay.

2:29

No, but it's good.

2:30

It's good.

2:30

Afterwards.

2:30

But I wanted to stop...

2:32

Uh, is it a way to stop him thinking because I want to change the prompt maybe?

2:38

I don't know.

2:39

At least I could have to try.

2:41

But like if I provide one more prompt and then he's thinking and I think that he's thinking too long and I want it to abort so I can rephrase the prompt.

2:50

Mo- maybe it's already there.

2:51

Maybe it's already there.

2:52

I don't know.

2:53

Hmm.

2:53

But I think-

2:54

Good points.

2:54

Yeah, I, I think it's, um, it's very simple.

2:58

It's like ChatGPT.

2:59

It's like you have the prompt, yeah, so it's easy to use.

3:04

Uh, do you have any other thoughts, comments, ideas, uh, to share about creating a piece of software with web coding tool?

3:17

I'm just...

3:17

my mind is just...

3:18

it's amazing.

3:19

It's just amazing.

3:21

I, I have the feeling that, uh, I can be a web developer without having studied, studying any programming at all.

3:31

Yeah, exactly, right?

3:32

Because I mean I have-

3:33

Because then developing becomes just like a teeny tiny part of, you know, maybe, you know, I don't know, like-

3:39

You only need to have the ideas, but-

3:41

...

3:41

building your business, or-

3:43

Yes.

3:43

You need to have the ideas-

3:44

...

3:44

building a pet project.

3:45

But you don't need to learn how to implement them.

3:49

And actually, so I, I have used MATLAB for many years, but I didn't use my programming knowledge.

3:58

Hmm.

3:58

So a person that does not know what a loop is, what if, nah, nah, nah, loop.

4:03

So- That, that sort of thing like, uh, you create a vector and then for each row in the vector, it makes a nah, nah, nah, and then you need to create some error message because you don't...

4:14

you want to notice when it stops or something like that.

4:17

That sort of programming thing, you, you don't need it here.

4:20

So-

4:20

Yeah.

4:21

You don't, you don't, um-

4:22

You don't need to-

4:23

It's unbelievable.

4:24

Y- you, you...

4:25

Yes, and-

4:25

...

4:25

learn your coding part.

4:27

And so basically, I, I just used normal language, say, "I want the check marks, I want the stars, nah, nah, nah, nah." That was it.

4:36

And, and th- the-

4:37

When you-

4:37

...

4:37

the trick that people know in ChatGPT, which is...

4:39

if there is a trick that I guess people are...

4:41

now know this, in...

4:42

be- when you start the prompt, you say, what the ChatGPT is, "You are my language editor," or, "You are my coauthor and you're writing an article for the American Computer Association." And it improves the results.

4:54

But here, I didn't use this trick.

4:57

I, I didn't say, "You are my professional web developer and you have 50 years of experience." I just did it normally and it was perfect.

5:06

Yeah, I'm super amazed with this.

5:09

And the last question, so do you feel that you learned something from, uh, participating in this experiment?

5:17

Of course, I have learned that this thing works.

5:20

Now I can start creating stuff because, uh, um, I heard about Lovable during Christmas from Christine.

5:27

Okay, so is she using herself or she was-

5:31

Uh, uh, she was, she was very excited, but I thought I, I should give it a try.

5:35

Mm-hmm.

5:35

But then, uh, well, I didn't still...

5:37

I didn't, didn't have time or some...

5:39

and now I, I, I had this opportunity.

5:41

Thank you very much.

5:42

Thank you for participating.

5:44

And, uh-

5:44

And, yeah.

5:45

I'm, I'm...

5:45

my mind is, is completely-

5:47

It's cool, right?

5:48

It is.

5:48

This is amazing.

5:49

This is really amazing.

5:50

And, uh, Marca Tea?